Name: Noah Jones
Age: 23
Gender: Non-Binary (They/Them)
Location: Lower-mainland, BC
Occupation: Electrican
Marital Status: Single

"If straight people don't have to "come out", why do queer people have to?"

Personal Bio

Noah is a, closeted, non-binary electrician for Ready Solar, a Burnaby based solar installation company found in British Columbia, Canada. After entering the trades industry as an apprentice electrician, Noah has immensely struggled adjusting to the trades culture. They find that they are constantly stressed and anxious because of having to hide their identity towards colleagues and employers, as they have spoken rudely about the LGBTQ+ community.

As a person, Noah enjoys celebrating their identity off the worksite, such as through pride and anonymous online community spaces. However, they struggle to feel truly happy and safe due to fear of being out-ed. The only solace Noah has is being able to vent to their one trade's friend that identifies as queer.

Key Behaviours and Tasks

- Tends to suppress their gender identity at work as a form of fear and defense.
- Sticks to the comfort of their close friend circle when they need to vent out feelings—both negative and positive.
- Actively involved in online LGBTQ+ spaces and communities that keeps their identity anonymous.
- Commonly uses their phone on-site for both personal and work use.
- Exerts a lot of physical strength and energy lifting heavy equipment on the job.

Must Haves

- Feel safe expressing identity anonymously.
- Get advice and guidance for workplace challenges from other gender-diverse people.
- Connect with other gender-diverse tradespeople and allies.
- Report harassment and unsafe behavior securely
- Quickly share location or call chosen contacts in emergencies.
- Access practical resources for handling bias and discrimination.
- Receive tools to manage stress, anxiety and mental health.

Goals and Motivations

- Being able to freely express themselves in a judgement free work environment.
- Having a community of gender-diverse people to bond with and rely on.
- Supporting and uplifting other gender-diverse people by reporting harassment incidents that they witness.
- Values personal privacy and anonymity when reporting harassment and safety incidents.
- Desires access to immediate safety resources and helplines on the job.

Pain Points and Frustrations

- **Stress from workplace aggression:** Noah faces subtle biases, rude comments and exclusion from colleagues, which increases anxiety and mental strain.
- **Risk of harassment or discrimination:** Noah's work colleagues have always had homophobic views towards the queer community, this causes him to feel isolated and severely affects his overall mental health.
- **Difficulty finding support and community:** Noah struggles to find safe, reliable spaces within the trades community where they can get advice, share experiences and connect with other LGBTQ+ tradespeople.
- **Fear of being outed:** Constantly hiding their identity creates tension and prevents them from fully participating at work or asking for help.
- **Uncertainly navigating workplace norms:** Homophobic comments over their use of pronouns, professional inclusion and inappropriate responses to bias adds to Noah's stress.

Technology Use

Noah uses social media to get support, stay informed and manage stress. They primarily use reddit and Instagram to gather information surrounding queer people in the trades industry.

Noah mostly uses their phone on the worksite, however they rely on their smart watch to keep them updated on important notifications and health related information.

- Mobile Phone
- Smart Watch
- Laptop

Never Do's

- Expose users' identities without consent.
- Allow harassment reports to be visible to coworkers or unauthorized people.
- Provide unverified, outdated or misleading advice.
- Overwhelm users with disorganized, cluttered or hard-to-navigate information.
- Make emergency features confusing or hard to access.
- Fail to protect sensitive data, including location or personal details.
- Let community spaces be unsafe or disrespectful.

References

MSBA, P. N. (2021b, June 5). Transgender and non-binary employees experience obstacles cisgendered do not. Psychology Today. https://www.psychologytoday.com/ca/blog/communication-success/202106/15-challenges-transgender-and-queer-employees-face-at-work

Team SafeSpace. (2025). PROJ02-02 User Research Findings Summary [Unpublished manuscript]. MDIA 3106 Design 3, British Columbia Institute of Technology.